Activity 01 - Conflict Signal Triage at LionCity Retail

Course: Mastering The Art of Conflict Resolution to Foster Team Collaboration and Success (TGS-2023021752) Duration: 45 minutes Materials: Signal log | stage map | triage matrix Output: A completed signal log, conflict-stage map and first-response decision with an escalation boundary.

Objective

Recognise early indicators, assess impact and decide the safe first response.

Psychological-safety boundary

Use only the fictional case. Do not require anyone to disclose a personal conflict. Any participant may call a pause or request another role. This learning activity does not replace organisational policy, HR advice or legal advice.

Scenario

LionCity Retail's Orchard service team is preparing for a major promotion. Over three weeks, two experienced staff have repeatedly swapped shifts, huddles have become quiet, and four customer handoffs were returned for missing information. Aisha privately tells supervisor Marcus that weekend duties are being allocated unfairly. Ben says Aisha is refusing to cooperate. Marcus has only fragments of chat messages and no agreed roster-change record. The promotion starts in five days.

Detailed instructions

Role cards

Give each participant only their own role before the first round. Observers use the checklist.

Marcus | Supervisor

Goal: protect service continuity and fairness. Private brief: Must decide what to clarify now and what requires escalation.

Aisha | Senior Associate

Goal: be heard without retaliation. Private brief: Believes patterns-not one incident-show unfair allocation.

Ben | Roster Coordinator

Goal: defend operational decisions. Private brief: Says changes followed availability and were not personal.

1. Read for observable facts. Read the LionCity Retail case once without discussing blame. Underline only what a person could directly see, hear, count or verify in a record.

2. Separate claims and interpretations. Place reported claims in a second column and interpretations in a third. Rewrite labels such as 'uncooperative' as specific behaviour, context and frequency.

3. Log the signals. Record each change in communication, attendance, coordination, quality or customer impact. Add the date or period, source and confidence level where the case supplies it.

4. Map the conflict stage. Place the signals on latent, perceived, felt and manifest stages. Note that stages can overlap and that missing evidence must remain marked as unknown.

5. Assess impact. Rate current impact on people, work, customers and risk as low, medium or high. Write one sentence of evidence for every rating.

6. Screen immediate risk. Check for safety threats, harassment, discrimination, retaliation, serious misconduct or an urgent operational hazard. If present, stop informal resolution and follow policy.

7. Generate response options. Consider monitor, clarify separately, convene a structured conversation, facilitate, or formally escalate. Do not assume a joint meeting is always safe or appropriate.

8. Select the first response. Choose the least intrusive safe response that protects people and work. Name the responsible person, the action and a deadline.

9. Set an escalation boundary. Write the trigger that would move the matter to HR, a designated grievance channel, security or another formal owner.

10. Peer challenge. Exchange the triage with another group. Ask them to identify one unsupported assumption and one risk that may have been missed.

11. Revise and submit. Correct the log, add unresolved questions and prepare a 60-second briefing that explains the decision without diagnosing anyone's personality.

Suggested timing

- 5 minutes - Individual case read
- 10 minutes - Signal log and fact/claim separation
- 8 minutes - Stage and impact mapping
- 7 minutes - Safety and policy screen
- 7 minutes - First-response decision
- 5 minutes - Peer challenge
- 3 minutes - Revision and briefing

Discussion questions

- Which details are observable facts, reported claims and interpretations?
- What indicators suggest latent, perceived, felt or manifest conflict?
- What immediate impact is visible for staff, customers and the promotion?
- What would make informal clarification unsafe or inappropriate?

Submission

Submit the completed worksheet and checklist. Use role names rather than real personal data, mark unresolved information as unknown and retain the artefact only through the approved course channel.

Debrief

The triage separates facts from assumptions, screens safety/policy risk and selects a proportionate next action.